

Budget vs Actual Performance — Executive Summary

Monthly Variance Analysis | Revenue & Expense Tracking | Forecast Accuracy

Business Problem

Management needs monthly visibility into where actual performance is diverging from budget — by revenue line, by expense category, and in aggregate — along with a reliable read on how accurate the forecasting process itself has been, in order to flag risk early and support confident capital and resourcing decisions.

Dataset

24 months of transactional data (Jan-25–Dec-26) across 4 revenue categories (Retail Sales, Wholesale, Online Sales, Foodservice) and 5 expense categories (COGS, Payroll, Marketing, Logistics, Admin), with Budget, Actual, and Forecast figures for each category-month.

Tools Used

Excel (SUMIFS-driven dynamic filtering, Data Validation, conditional formatting, native charting), MAPE-based forecast accuracy methodology.

Key Insights

- Revenue tracked budget almost exactly over the full period (+0.02% variance), while expenses came in 0.08% under budget — a combined net positive variance of £29,783 against plan.
- Forecast accuracy averaged 96.1% across the 24-month period, calculated using Mean Absolute Percentage Error (MAPE) rather than a simple average — avoiding the common pitfall of offsetting errors masking true forecast quality.
- Category-level variance analysis surfaced individual cost lines running materially over or under budget even when the aggregate expense variance looked healthy — the kind of detail a single "total" KPI would hide.

Impact

Metric	Result
Revenue Variance (Full Period)	+0.02% vs. Budget
Expense Variance (Full Period)	-0.08% vs. Budget
Net Variance	+£29,783
Forecast Accuracy (MAPE-based)	96.1%

Dashboard Preview

